

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Private Client Paralegal position at your Wokingham office, as advertised through G2 Legal. Your firm's Legal 500 and Chambers ranking, and the long-term career pathway this role represents, are the principal reasons I'm writing.

My background is weighted toward disputes and advisory work, and I recognise that private client law is a distinct specialism. That said, the core competencies I've developed map directly onto what a client-facing paralegal role of this kind requires: taking detailed factual instructions from individuals in sensitive circumstances, identifying legal and evidential issues, managing matters from instruction through to completion, and translating complex rules into clear practical guidance.

At Citizens Advice East Berkshire, I advise clients daily on welfare, housing, family and debt matters — areas where accuracy, procedural knowledge and client-focused judgement matter as much as technical legal skill. I draft correspondence, prepare applications and document schedules, maintain confidential records and manage competing deadlines across an active caseload. Many of the clients I work with are vulnerable, which has sharpened my instinct for handling sensitive matters carefully and communicating with clarity.

At BCLP, I supported a complex investment arbitration and a real estate disputes team across a full year's placement. I drafted procedural documents, prepared hearing bundles, reviewed evidence and helped maintain structured case files under time pressure — including becoming the sole junior supporting a team shortly before a significant deadline. A partner and associate told me my performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor.

I hold a 2:1 LLB from UCL and an LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution from Queen Mary (Merit), with a Distinction in my dissertation. I am based in Maidenhead, so Wokingham is a straightforward commute.

I am aware that moving into private client law means a learning curve, and I would bring the same approach I've applied elsewhere: structured, thorough, and focused on delivering an exceptional service to clients. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience fits the team's needs.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Fernanda Silva